

Apart from the ease of administration, it triggers an immune response in the nose and upper airway, blocking the infection and breaking the chain of transmission. Further, this vaccine can be quickly modified to combat emerging variants. “Despite all the advantages and great R&D, iNCOVACC is a late entrant in the Covid-19 vaccines market,” says Girdhar Gyani, Director General, Association of Healthcare Providers (India). At present 98 per cent of the Indian population has already taken at least one dose and 92 per cent have taken both doses of the Covid-19 vaccine, leaving little scope for the new Bharat Biotech vaccine. The vaccine has the maximum potential to target the children’s population but it has only been approved for adults.

₹800 per dose EXPECTED PRICE OF BHARAT BIOTECH’S NASAL VACCINE IN THE PRIVATE MARKET

While the company has not shared any details about its capacity and number of doses manufactured, sources tell *BT* that the central government has not placed any orders even after one month of its approval. “The government will not procure the nasal vaccine because we have surplus vaccines in

stock. Serum Institute of India has also recently donated over 20 million doses of Covishield. Procuring more vaccines will not serve any purpose,” a senior official in the Union health ministry says.

The pricing of the vaccine is also not conducive. According to the company, it will be priced at ₹800 per dose in the private market and at ₹325 per dose for procurement by central and state governments.

“Now only 30 per cent people are left to take boosters. Further, when other vaccines such as Covaxin and Covishield are available free of cost, people will not go for such an expensive vaccine,” says Gyani. *BT*

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WINTER WARMTH FOR MOVIES

Return of the Big Screen

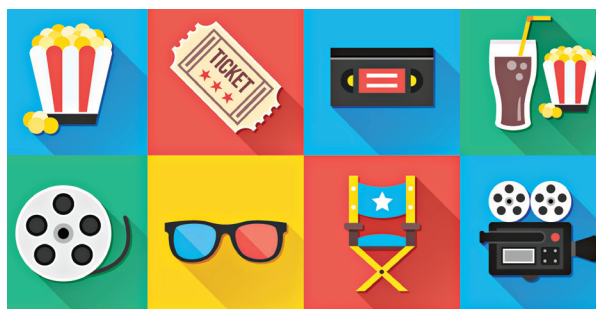
The positive after-effects of *Pathaan* are likely to sweep Bollywood in 2023

BY SOHINI MITTER

► **THE SHAH RUKH** Khan (SRK)-Deepika Padukone starrer *Pathaan*, marking SRK’s return to the screens after four years, has hit it out of the park. The film has grossed a mammoth ₹542 crore in worldwide collections in just five days. *Pathaan* is being called a movement of sorts, with revenge-watching and positive ‘word of mouth’ driving the collections. The positive after-effects of this tent pole release are likely to sweep Bollywood in 2023.

Analysts say the fate of Hindi cinema will also go on to determine the financials of the box office in Q4FY23. “A blend of large-scale content and a mega-star such as SRK may provide the much-needed respite to Bollywood, as *Pathaan* may turn out to be the highest-grossing Hindi film in the post-Covid-19 era, surpassing *Brahmastra* and *Drishyam 2*,” says Karan Taurani, SVP at Elara Capital.

The turnaround for multiplexes began in the December quarter. While Hollywood made a strong comeback in the Indian market with titles like *Avatar 2: The Way of Water* and *Black Panther: Wakanda Forever*, regional cinema, especially movies from the South—from blockbust-



ers like *Ponniyin Selvan 1* to sleeper hits like *Kantara*—continued their pan-India dominance.

PVR, India’s largest multiplex operator, turned a profit of ₹16.15 crore in Q3FY23, after posting 10 successive quarters of losses since the pandemic. Its revenues also jumped 53 per cent to ₹940.69 crore, riding on higher ticket prices and spending per head. *BT*

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